

Iran War — Energy & Regional Security Timeline

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Situation Brief

The current escalation level in the Iran-Israel-US conflict is critical, primarily driven by Iran's aggressive actions, including missile strikes on energy facilities in Qatar and Saudi Arabia, which signal a direct threat to Gulf energy security. These attacks have resulted in significant damage to key energy infrastructure, raising immediate concerns over the stability of oil supply chains and the potential for military responses from Gulf states. The heightened tensions have already led to a notable increase in crude prices, with Brent rising by 6% following the attacks, indicating a tightening energy market. The situation is further complicated by Trump's threats to target Iranian gas facilities, which could exacerbate market volatility and disrupt global energy supplies. The most important development to watch next is the potential shift in Gulf states' defensive postures towards more aggressive military actions in response to Iranian provocations, which could significantly impact oil infrastructure and transit through the Strait of Hormuz.

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Critical Developments (Next 24–48h Focus)

Iran Missile Strikes on Qatar Energy Facilities

Iran's missile attacks have caused extensive damage to Qatar's energy infrastructure, directly threatening oil supply stability and potentially leading to immediate disruptions in regional energy markets.

Saudi Arabia's Warning of Military Action

Saudi Arabia's indication of potential military responses to Iranian provocations raises the risk of conflict in the Gulf, which could severely disrupt transit routes through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical chokepoint for global oil shipments.

Trump's Threat to Target Iran's South Pars Gasfield

Trump's aggressive stance towards Iran's South Pars gasfield in response to further attacks could escalate military tensions, increasing the risk of retaliatory strikes that would destabilize energy supplies and heighten market volatility.

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Market Snapshot

As of Mar 18, 2026 16:30 Eastern Daylight Time
Market Regime: Structural Tightening (Distillate Driven)

WTI 94.30	Brent 103.55	Nat Gas 2.96
VIX 21.52	10Y 4.26	Dollar 99.74

Refining Spread: +67.8 (Extreme Distillate Tightness)

SYSTEM STRESS

Jet Fuel 3.86 ~162/bbl	Cheniere (LNG) 266.22	BDRY ETF 10.7
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Situation Summary

Events Detected: 75
High Severity: 75
Primary Actor: Iran/IRGC
Actor Concentration: 99% Iran/IRGC
Escalation Level: Critical
Market Regime: Structural Tightening

Event Timeline

EVENT CLUSTER — Strikes hit world’s largest natural gas field in Iran, and Tehran retaliates with more attacks

ELEVATED IRAN/IRGC MILITARY VERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · Iowa Public Radio, PBS, Straight Arrow News - SAN

The recent strikes on Iran's largest natural gas field, coupled with Tehran's retaliatory actions, significantly heighten the risk of supply disruptions in the energy market, potentially destabilizing regional security and impacting global gas prices.

39 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 1 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran hits back at multiple Gulf refineries after Israeli strike on its offshore gas field

ELEVATED **IRAN/IRGC** **MILITARY** **VERIFIED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · WSAW, WFAA, NBC 7 San Diego

The Iranian response to the Israeli strike on its offshore gas field, targeting multiple Gulf refineries, significantly heightens regional tensions and poses an immediate threat to energy security in the Gulf, potentially disrupting oil supply chains and increasing market volatility.

8 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 2 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Hezbollah fires rockets at north; Iran launches 6th missile salvo at Israel since midnight

ELEVATED **IRAN/IRGC** **IRAN STRIKE** **CORROBORATED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · The Times of Israel, arabnews.jp, The Times of India

The recent escalation in hostilities, marked by Hezbollah's rocket fire and Iran's missile strikes on Israel, significantly heightens regional security risks, potentially disrupting energy supply chains and exacerbating volatility in global oil markets.

3 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 3 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Gulf states have tolerated Iranian strikes so far — but their 'defensive' stance won't last forever

ELEVATED **IRAN/IRGC** **GULF IMPACT** **CORROBORATED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · CNBC, CBC, WTOP

The ongoing Iranian strikes in the Gulf, coupled with a high-severity escalation, signal an imminent tightening of energy market security, as Gulf states may soon shift from a defensive posture to more aggressive measures, potentially disrupting oil supply chains.

4 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 4 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Brent crude up 6%, gas prices soar 30% after attacks on energy facilities in Qatar, Iran

ELEVATED **IRAN/IRGC** **OIL INFRA** **CORROBORATED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · CNBC

The recent attacks on energy facilities in Qatar and Iran by the IRGC have triggered a significant spike in Brent crude prices by 6% and a 30% surge in gas prices, indicating heightened regional security risks and potential disruptions in global oil supply.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 5 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Trump threatens to ‘blow up’ all of Iran’s South Pars gasfield if Tehran strikes Qatar

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

GULF IMPACT

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *The Guardian*

The heightened tensions following Trump's threat to target Iran's South Pars gasfield in response to potential Iranian aggression towards Qatar could significantly disrupt regional energy supplies and elevate market volatility.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 6 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran strikes Gulf energy sites: Kuwait, Qatar, UAE, Saudi refineries hit

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

IRAN STRIKE

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *조선일보, Gulf News, The Jerusalem Post*

The recent Iranian strikes on Gulf energy sites, including refineries in Kuwait, Qatar, the UAE, and Saudi Arabia, significantly heighten regional security risks and could lead to immediate disruptions in global oil supply and price volatility.

3 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 7 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — ‘Will Not Hesitate...’: Trump Warns of Massive Retaliation After Iran Strikes Qatar LNG Facilities

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

IRAN STRIKE

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *NDTV, Open Magazine*

The heightened tensions following Iran's strike on Qatar's LNG facilities, coupled with Trump's warning of massive retaliation, signal an immediate tightening of energy markets and increased regional security risks, potentially disrupting global LNG supply chains.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 8 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Trump claims Israel attacked South Pars alone and vows no more strikes after Iran's retaliation

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

MILITARY

UNVERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *thenationalnews.com*

The heightened military tensions following Trump's assertion of Israel's unilateral attack on South Pars and Iran's subsequent retaliation could significantly disrupt energy supply stability in the region, exacerbating market volatility and security concerns.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 9 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Israel kills Iran's intelligence chief as both sides ratchet up attacks on energy facilities

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

MILITARY

UNVERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · France 24

The assassination of Iran's intelligence chief by Israel significantly heightens military tensions in the region, posing an immediate threat to energy security and stability in oil markets as both nations escalate attacks on critical energy infrastructure.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 10 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Qatar's emir urges halt to US-Iran escalation after attack on gas facility

SEVERE

IRAN/IRGC

GULF IMPACT

UNVERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · Anadolu Ajansı

The recent attack on a gas facility has heightened tensions in the Gulf, prompting Qatar's emir to call for a de-escalation of US-Iran hostilities, which could significantly impact regional energy security and market stability.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 11 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Oil rises after Iran strikes Middle East energy facilities

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

IRAN STRIKE

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · CNBC Africa, The Guardian

The recent Iranian strikes on Middle East energy facilities have led to a significant spike in oil prices, heightening regional security risks and tightening global energy markets.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 12 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Trump attempts to distance US from Israeli strikes on key Iranian gasfield

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

MILITARY

VERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · Al Jazeera

The U.S. distancing from Israeli military actions against Iranian gasfields heightens regional tensions and could disrupt energy supplies, exacerbating market volatility amid an already precarious security landscape.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 13 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Israel strikes Iran's South Pars gasfield hours after forces kill intelligence minister

CRITICAL

IRAN/IRGC

ISRAEL STRIKE

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *The Guardian*

The Israeli strike on Iran's South Pars gasfield, following the assassination of an Iranian intelligence minister, significantly heightens regional tensions and poses immediate risks to energy supply stability in the Gulf.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 14 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Trump Promises Israel Won't Repeat Strike on Key Iranian Gas Field

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

OIL INFRA

CORROBORATED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *Crude Oil Prices Today | OilPrice.com*

The heightened tensions following Trump's assurance that Israel will refrain from targeting critical Iranian gas infrastructure could lead to immediate tightening in oil markets, exacerbating regional energy security concerns.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 15 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Qatar expels Iranian military attaché from Doha following strikes

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

GULF IMPACT

UNVERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *i24NEWS*

The expulsion of the Iranian military attaché from Qatar amid rising tensions following recent strikes significantly heightens the risk of regional instability, potentially disrupting energy supply routes and elevating oil market volatility.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 16 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — The New York Times. . Our national security reporter David E. Sanger describes how President Trump is considering a risky commando operation at an Iranian nuclear site. Read more: <https://nyti.ms/4byQ9uT>

CRITICAL

IRAN/IRGC

NUCLEAR

UNVERIFIED

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · *facebook.com*

The potential for a U.S. commando operation targeting an Iranian nuclear site raises immediate concerns over energy market volatility and regional security, as heightened tensions could disrupt oil supply routes and escalate conflict in the Gulf.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 17 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran's hidden mountain nuclear site raises urgent threat, must be 'neutralized': reports

ELEVATED **IRAN/IRGC** **NUCLEAR** **CORROBORATED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · Fox News, AOL.com

The discovery of Iran's concealed nuclear facility heightens regional security risks and could lead to immediate disruptions in energy markets as tensions escalate.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 18 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — US intelligence chief denies Iranian nuclear threat, but in court does not contradict Trump

CRITICAL **IRAN/IRGC** **NUCLEAR** **UNVERIFIED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · Il Sole 24 ORE

The ongoing tensions surrounding Iran's nuclear ambitions, underscored by the US intelligence chief's ambiguous stance, heighten the risk of supply disruptions in the energy market, particularly in the Gulf region, as geopolitical uncertainties escalate.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 19 of 20

EVENT CLUSTER — Israel strikes Iran's South Pars gas field

CRITICAL **IRAN/IRGC** **ISRAEL STRIKE** **UNVERIFIED**

Mar 19 6:00 · HIGH · immediate · CNN

The Israeli strike on Iran's South Pars gas field significantly heightens regional tensions and poses an immediate risk to global energy markets by threatening Iran's gas production capabilities and potentially disrupting supply chains.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 20 of 20

Iran War Reference

Iran Oil Exports: ~1.5-2M bbl/day (sanctions-constrained) · Primary buyers: China, Syria

Key Infrastructure: Kharg Island terminal ~90% of exports · Abadan refinery · Isfahan refinery

Nuclear Sites: Fordow (underground) · Natanz · Arak heavy water reactor

US Forces: 3 carrier strike groups · Fifth Fleet (Bahrain) · ~40,000 troops in region

Chokepoint Risk: Strait of Hormuz ~21M bbl/day · Iran controls northern shore

Gulf State Exposure: Saudi ~9M bbl/day · UAE ~3M bbl/day · Kuwait ~2.5M bbl/day · Iraq ~4M bbl/day

Proxy Network: Hezbollah (Lebanon) · Houthi (Yemen) · PMF (Iraq) · Hamas (Gaza)

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